Ernest Reschke Personal Statement

My career goals did not come from directly watching my dad live them out day to day, but instead through the stories he shared with me growing up. When he was in college, he joined ROTC with two intentions: to provide long-term stability for his family and to travel. Over the course of his 23-year military career, he accomplished both. Through his experiences, I developed my own understanding of what success looks like, not just financially, but in terms of freedom, impact, and the ability to build a meaningful life. Because of that, I have always been motivated to pursue opportunities that challenge me, allow me to grow, and ultimately position me to create meaningful impact through my work.

I am drawn to environments that push me to improve. Whether in engineering, business, or personal experiences, I consistently choose the more difficult path because it forces growth. Over time, I have developed a mindset centered around adaptability, persistence, and continuous improvement. That mindset has shaped how I approach both my education and my professional experiences, and continues to guide the opportunities I pursue.

I am an extrovert who values relationships and shared experiences. I care deeply about my family and friends, and they are a major source of motivation in my life. A large part of my identity has also been shaped by my experience at Kettering University through leadership positions within my fraternity. Serving as Recruitment Chair and later as External Vice President, I oversaw and grew a 30-member chapter. In these roles, I led recruitment initiatives, built relationships with other campus organizations, and coordinated large-scale events with over 300 attendees. These experiences pushed me to develop leadership, organizational, and communication skills in real time, often requiring me to make quick decisions and adapt to changing situations.

Beyond the operational side of leadership, these roles also had a personal impact on me. Through my fraternity, I developed some of my closest friendships, relationships that have become a core part of my support system and personal growth. Leading within that environment taught me to balance accountability with empathy and to motivate a group toward a shared goal while maintaining a strong sense of community. Outside of academics and leadership, I play hockey and golf, both of which have taught me discipline, consistency, and how to perform under pressure. I am also a certified sailor and have a strong interest in travel, which aligns with my goal of experiencing different environments and perspectives

Additionally, I served as the captain of my esports team for two years, competing in Valorant. In this role, I led my team to a league championship, which required not only technical skill but also strong communication, strategy, and the ability to keep a team focused under pressure. This experience reinforced my ability to lead in competitive environments and highlighted the importance of preparation, adaptability, and trust within a team.

My interest in engineering began in high school, when I took apart a computer and became fascinated by how hardware and software interact. That curiosity led me to pursue a

degree in computer engineering at Kettering University, where I have developed both technical knowledge and hands-on experience. One of the most meaningful academic projects I completed was a Spotify playback controller built on an ESP32 microcontroller. The system integrated physical controls with software written in C and used the Spotify API to manage playback and display album art. This project demonstrated my ability to take an idea from concept to implementation while strengthening my interest in both engineering design and business principles. Through my cooperative education experiences, I have expanded that foundation across multiple industries, ranging from large-scale manufacturing environments to more dynamic and fast-paced organizations. At Marmon Holdings, a Berkshire Hathaway company, I gained exposure to structured engineering processes and how large organizations operate efficiently at scale. During my thesis project with Detroit Diesel, I developed an automated testing toolchain that integrated multiple testing platforms into GitHub, reducing engineers' testing time by approximately 20 percent. In this role, I took initiative by identifying inefficiencies in the testing workflow and working across teams to implement a solution that improved both productivity and reliability.

In Charleston, I worked in a lean engineering environment, contributing to process improvements within operational workflows. By analyzing inefficiencies in material flow and communication between teams, I helped support changes that improved overall organization and reduced delays. This experience strengthened my understanding of how engineering decisions directly impact business performance and reinforced my interest in both engineering design and business principles. I have also intentionally pursued opportunities outside traditional engineering roles to further develop my business skills. While working in Florida as a door-to-door pest control sales representative, I operated in a performance-based environment where success depended entirely on my ability to communicate value and adapt to rejection. In addition to developing sales skills, I demonstrated initiative by adjusting my approach based on customer feedback and refining my strategy daily to improve results.

During this experience, I also faced significant personal and professional challenges. I was placed in a team environment that did not align with my values, which created tension in both communication and collaboration. Rather than disengaging, I focused on maintaining professionalism, continuing to perform my responsibilities, and seeking support from my network when needed. At the same time, I navigated a major personal setback, which required me to stay disciplined and focused despite difficult circumstances. This experience strengthened my resilience and reinforced my ability to perform under pressure while maintaining integrity. Currently, I work at a startup called Socialync, where I contribute in a fast-paced, evolving environment. In this role, I have taken on responsibilities spanning multiple disciplines, working on both technical and business challenges. For example, I have assisted in improving internal processes while also contributing to customer-facing initiatives, which have required strong communication and adaptability. This experience has further developed my ability to think across functions and reinforced my interest in working at the intersection of engineering and business.

I am particularly interested in roles that allow me to operate at this intersection. I am comfortable working in both technical and business environments, and I enjoy bridging the gap between the

two. At its core, both engineering and business are centered around problem-solving, whether that problem is technical, operational, or strategic. My experiences across different industries, leadership roles, and team environments have prepared me to approach problems from multiple perspectives and contribute in a meaningful way.

Looking forward, I want to be part of an organization where I can make a direct impact, continue developing my skills, and contribute to a team working toward a common goal. I am especially drawn to environments that value collaboration, adaptability, and continuous improvement. I am motivated by challenge, driven by growth, and committed to applying both my engineering background and business experience to create value.

Ultimately, my goal is to build a career that combines technical expertise with business impact. I want to continue growing as both an engineer and as a professional who understands how to drive results within an organization. I am confident in my ability to adapt, take initiative, and contribute meaningfully in any environment I am part of.